only know this because Tenielle told me afterwards. My problem is that I can never say no to people who buy me drinks. I always feel rude and disrespectful.

At that time we were renting a place on Kloof Nek Road in the city – a development called the Summit. To get there from Camps Bay is just a short drive up and over the Nek, but I decided to take the long way round via Green Point in order to stop by Steers, a burger joint.

So we drive through Camps Bay to Green Point Main Road, both of us happy as hell. The music is blaring in the car, and at the traffic lights outside the old News Café, we get pulled over by the police. Apparently I had been driving pretty fast. I was in a confident frame of mind. 'Don't worry,' I said to Tenielle. 'I'll handle this.'

I was sure they would know who I was and that things would turn out all right. As it happened, these two didn't know me from Adam. 'Sir,' the one officer asks, 'have you been drinking?'

'Ja,' I said, confidently. What else could I say? So he said, 'Okay, will you come to the station with us, please?' They put me in the back of the van and took me to Sea Point Police Station. Tenielle had to drive our car back to the police station, and she sat there for a while before eventually going home.

For some reason the cops didn't have breathalyser equipment at the station, so they carted me all the way to a roadblock set up on the N2. As a result of my drunken state, I can vaguely remember sitting in the back of the van and abusing the cop, because he was driving at what felt like 160 km/h. 'What the fuck? You pull me over for a little speeding down the main road and here you are, driving 160 kays an hour. What's with you?'

Quite quickly we arrived at the mobile police station on the N2, and there's a queue of seven or eight people, all lining up to get breathalysed. Now I'm starting to get irritable – really irritable – and I am not being my usual jovial self. So I abuse the good officers a little more and suggest they phone President Thabo Mbeki and tell him who and where I am, and he would order them to let me go. Of course the officers declined to call the president.

Instead they made me blow into the breathalyser, which was apparently a new type of device. After doing this I saw a woman officer and demanded to make a phone call. I went on about knowing my rights, etcetera. So she